KELAB BRIDGE DAN CATUR
UNIVERSITI SAINS MALAYSIA
Pusat Mahasiswa, Bangunan H21, Kompleks Cahaya Siswa, 11800 USM,
Pulau Pinang, Malaysia.
Tel: 04 – 6579908 ext. 3491 Fax: 04 – 6581745
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KNIGHT'S VALOR: QUEST FOR THE CROWN - USM 32ND CHESS TEAM OPEN TOURNAMENT 2026

Date	: 7th June 2026 (Sunday)
Time	: 7:30 a.m. - 6:30 p.m. (GMT +8)
Venue	: Dewan Utama Pelajar, Universiti Sains Malaysia
Opening Date (Early-Bird)	: 6th April 2026 (Monday), 8:00 a.m. (GMT+8)
Closing Date (Early-Bird)	: 19th April 2026 (Sunday), 11:59 p.m. (GMT +8)
Opening Date (Standard)	: 20th April 2026 (Monday), 12:00 a.m. (GMT+8)
Closing Date (Standard)	: 17th May 2026 (Sunday), 11:59 p.m. (GMT +8) OR 52 registered teams

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Eligibility of Participants:

1. This tournament is open to all players.
2. There offers the following categories of play:

Open	Ladies	IPTA/IPTS
U18	U12	

***Age of player is determined as of 1st January 2026.

3. Age Criteria:
    a. **Ladies Category**: Include only the team whose players are all ladies.
    b. **IPTA/IPTS Category**: Include only the team whose players are all university students.
    c. **U18 Category**: Only players born on or after 1st January 2008 are eligible.
    d. **U12 Category**: Only players born on or after 1st January 2014 are eligible.
4. A younger player can register for a higher-age group but **NOT** vice versa under any circumstances.
5. In the event of limited resources or scheduling conflicts, categories will be given priority in the following order:
    ➢ **Open > Ladies > IPTA/IPTS > U18 > U12**
6. Participants must ensure they meet the eligibility criteria for their respective categories. Any violation may result in disqualification.
7. Each team must consist of exactly **4** players only. **NO** reserve player is allowed. The players should be registered online **as per board order** upon submission. Changing of board order is **NOT** allowed after registration.

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8. If team members are not in the same category, then the team's category will be considered as the **highest priority of the category of members in that team**.

Tournament Regulations:

1. Tournament Format:
   (a) The tournament will use the **Swiss System**, with **7 rounds for TEAM** (depending on the number of participants).
   (b) Pairings will be generated using the **Swiss Manager Program**.
   (c) The pairing list will be generated regardless of participant categories, meaning players **may face opponents from different categories** (Cross-age pairing is possible).
2. Rules and Time Control:
   (a) The tournament will adhere to **FIDE rules and regulations**, except where noted otherwise.
   (b) The time control will be **15 minutes with 5 seconds increment per move** for each player.
3. All players shall report their attendance **before 8:20 a.m.** at the registration counter. Walk-in registration is **NOT** permitted.
4. Players who are **not present within 15 minutes** after the game has started will lose by default (walkover). Teams may be disqualified if the entire team is absent for 2 consecutive rounds.
5. All players are expected to maintain a high standard of sportsmanship and fair play throughout the tournament.
6. Use of mobile phones or any electronic means of communication is **prohibited** in the playing venue, which is the tournament hall. Violation of this rule will result in an **automatic loss** of the game.
7. Any behavior that disrupts the orderly conduct of the game, such as making excessive noise, disturbing opponents, or any other violation of the tournament rules, is **strictly prohibited.**
8. If a player is found to be in violation of these rules, a **warning** will be issued to the player. This warning will be recorded.
9. Upon receiving the **fifth warning**, the player's game will be declared lost, regardless of the position on the board.
10. Players are only allowed **2 illegal moves**. If a player makes a third completed illegal move, the arbiter will declare the game lost for that player.
11. Players are expected to dress smartly at all times in the waiting and playing hall. Casual wear is recommended. For instance, collar shirts or T-shirts, jeans or skirts (for women), and shoes. Skirts that are above knees and slippers are **NOT** allowed.

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12. If any player is found to have altered the order of the boards, the specific board(s) involved in the change will be declared as **WARNING**. This penalty applies only to the individual board(s) where the order was changed, **NOT** to the entire team's performance in the tournament.
13. Recording of moves is **NOT** compulsory, but scoresheets will be provided upon request.
14. Food and drinks are **NOT** allowed in the playing hall.
15. The arbiter reserves the right to penalize offending players who violate any of the rules. Options available to the arbiter concerning penalties are:
    a. A warning,
    b. Declaring the game to be lost by the offending player (the arbiter shall also decide the opponent's score),
    c. Expulsion from the competition.
16. A team may win only **ONE prize (exclude best board prizes)**. If a team qualifies for prizes in more than one category, the **above hierarchy will be applied**.
17. Tie-Breaks:
    - ➢ Match Point (2 for Wins, 1 for Draws, 0 for Losses)
    - ➢ Game Points
    - ➢ Buchholz Tie-Break Variable (2023) (0,0,0,-,-,0)
18. The Organizing Committee (OC) has the final say on all decisions and no further appeals will be entertained after a final ruling.

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Tentative Flow:

7:30 a.m. - 8:30 a.m.	Registration
8:30 a.m. - 8:45 a.m.	Opening Ceremony
8:45 a.m. - 9:00 a.m.	Arbiter & Swiss Briefing + Q & A Session
9:00 a.m. - 10:00 a.m.	Round 1
10:00 a.m. - 11:00 a.m.	Round 2
11:00 a.m. - 12:00 p.m.	Round 3
12:00 p.m.- 1:00 p.m.	Round 4
1:00 p.m. - 2:00 p.m.	Lunch Break
2:00 p.m. - 3:00 p.m.	Round 5
3:00 p.m. - 4:00 p.m.	Round 6
4:00 p.m. - 5:00 p.m.	Round 7
5:00 p.m. - 5:30 p.m.	Break Time
5:30 p.m. - 6:30 p.m.	Closing Ceremony

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Prize List:

Open Category	
Champion	RM 800 + Medal + Certificate
1st Runner-Up	RM 500 + Medal + Certificate
2nd Runner-Up	RM 340 + Medal + Certificate
4th Place	RM 300 + Medal + Certificate
5th Place	RM 300 + Medal + Certificate

Ladies Category	
1st Place	RM 200 + Medal + Certificate

IPTA/IPTS Category	
1st Place	Medal + Certificate
2nd Place	Medal + Certificate
3rd Place	Medal + Certificate

U18 Category	
1st Place	Medal + Certificate
2nd Place	Medal + Certificate
3rd Place	Medal + Certificate

U12 Category	
1st Place	Medal + Certificate
2nd Place	Medal + Certificate
3rd Place	Medal + Certificate

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Special Prizes - Best Board Player (Only Top 1 for Each Board)	
Board 1	Trophy + Certificate
Board 2	Trophy + Certificate
Board 3	Trophy + Certificate
Board 4	Trophy + Certificate

** Each player is entitled to win **ONE prize** only (excluding the Special Prizes).

** If a team qualifies for prizes in more than one category, the above hierarchy will be applied.

** The Prize List is **subject to change** without prior notice.

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Participation Fee:

Category	Participation Fee	
	Early Bird	**Normal**
PCA member	RM 80	RM 100
Non-PCA member	RM 100	RM 120
International	RM 160 (or equivalent in other currencies)	RM 260 (or equivalent in other currencies)

* 1 team consists of **4 players**

* PCA – Penang Chess Association

* Only eligible for PCA members of the **year 2026**.

* Players that are **Malaysian nationals** (**Malaysian NRIC holders**) but **NOT PCA Members** are considered as **Non-PCA Members**.

* Players who **do not hold Malaysian citizenship** or **Permanent Resident (PR) status** are considered as **International Participants.**

** If any wrong payment is made, the **registration will be cancelled**.

** **Refund policy:** Open Tournament 2026 Refund Policy.pdf

** **Late registration fee:** Participants who register after the normal registration is closed will be charged with a late registration fee of **RM20.** All final decisions on late registrations will be made by the organizing committee.

*** Teams that consist of **4 PCA Members** are considered as a **PCA Team**.

*** Teams that consist of **at least 1 Non-PCA Member** are considered as a **Non-PCA Team**.

*** Teams that consist of **at least 1 International Participant** are considered as an **International Team**.

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Registration Method:

Please visit: https://tinyurl.com/OT26-TEAM-REGISTRATION

Payment Method:

Bank transfer to the following bank account:

Name : UNIVERSITI SAINS MALAYSIA

Bank : CIMB Bank Berhad

Account Number : 98986101110942

** All payments should be made before the closing date of registration.

Contact Person:

For any inquiries regarding the tournament, please contact:

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For more information regarding the tournament/rules,

Please visit: USM 31st Chess Open Tournament Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)